

EZTV Free-Text Search Integration Research

Date: 2026-06-13 **Author:** research subagent (lava-api-go curated-providers stream) **Scope:** Determine the *honest* way to make EZTV usable as a free-text-searchable curated provider in lava-api-go, or prove it cannot be done anonymously and recommend the alternative. **Constitutional frame:** §6.E (Capability Honesty — a declared SEARCH capability MUST genuinely filter by the query) + §6.L / §6.J (no bluff: a search that ignores the query is forbidden). §11.4.6 no-guessing vocabulary applied throughout — captured facts are stated as facts; anything not directly observed is marked UNCONFIRMED:.

1. Probes run (literal commands + captured-output excerpts)

All probes are bounded single curl/python3 invocations (no loops), run live on 2026-06-13.

Probe 1 + 2 — keywords= param is silently ignored (re-confirm)

```
curl -s "https://eztvx.to/api/get-torrents?
limit=5&page=1&keywords=ironman"
curl -s "https://eztvx.to/api/get-torrents?
limit=5&page=1&keywords=batman"
```

Both responses begin **identically**:

```
keywords=ironman →
{"torrents_count":1055208,"limit":5,"page":1,"torrents":
[{"id":3110192,...,"title":"Iron Man and His Awesome Friends
S01E28 720p WEB H264-AF0 EZTV",...},
{...Deadliest.Catch.S22E06...}]}
keywords=batman →
{"torrents_count":1055208,"limit":5,"page":1,"torrents":
[{"id":3110192,...,"title":"Iron Man and His Awesome Friends
```

```
S01E28 720p WEB H264-AF0 EZTV",...},
{...Deadliest.Catch.S22E06...}]}}
```

FACT: `torrents_count` is 1055208 for both; the first torrent for `keywords=batman` is *"Iron Man and His Awesome Friends"* — the global latest-torrents list, unfiltered. The `keywords` param is a no-op. (Matches the main stream's earlier finding; count moved 1,055,207 → 1,055,208 only because the global feed grew by one row between sessions.)

Probe 7 — `?q=` and `?search=` aliases are ALSO ignored

```
curl -s "https://eztvx.to/api/get-torrents?limit=1&q=batman"
| grep -o '"torrents_count":[0-9]*' → "torrents_count":1055208
curl -s "https://eztvx.to/api/get-torrents?limit=1&search=batman"
| grep -o '"torrents_count":[0-9]*' → "torrents_count":1055208
```

FACT: Neither `q` nor `search` filters; both return the same global count. There is no free-text param on the JSON API under any of the three names tried.

Probe 3 + 4 + 11 — `imdb_id=` param GENUINELY filters (but is TV-only and zero-pad-sensitive)

```
curl -s "https://eztvx.to/api/get-torrents?
limit=3&imdb_id=0372784" (Batman Begins, a film) →
{"imdb_id":"0372784","torrents_count":0,...}
curl -s "https://eztvx.to/api/get-torrents?
limit=3&imdb_id=0944947" (Game of Thrones) →
{"imdb_id":"0944947","torrents_count":146,"torrents":
[ {...,"title":"Game of Thrones S01E10 2160p UHD BluRay x265-
SCOTLUHD EZTV","imdb_id":"0944947",...}]}}
```

Zero-padding is **load-bearing**:

```
curl -s ".../get-torrents?limit=1&imdb_id=944947" →
"torrents_count":0
curl -s ".../get-torrents?limit=1&imdb_id=0944947" →
"torrents_count":146
```

FACT: `imdb_id` is a real filter. All returned rows for GoT are titled "Game of Thrones". A film (Batman Begins) returns 0 → EZTV is a TV-only catalogue. The id **MUST** be the zero-padded 7-digit form (0944947), not the integer-stripped form (944947). IMDb's own `ttXXXXXXX` id already carries this padding; the correct transform is `strip("tt")`, NOT `int()`.

Probe 5 — HTML search page /search/<query> is HARD Cloudflare-gated

```
curl -s -A "Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64) AppleWebKit/537.36"
"https://eztvx.to/search/game-of-thrones" -D -
```

Response headers + body:

```
HTTP/2 403
cf-mitigated: challenge
server: cloudflare
content-security-policy: ... https://challenges.cloudflare.com ...
server-timing: chlray;desc="a0afb7828c2776ef"
--- body markers found: "Just a moment", "challenge-platform",
"cloudflare"
--- count of "game of thrones" in body: 0
--- body size: 5536 bytes (the CF interstitial, not a results
page)
```

FACT: The HTML search page returns **HTTP 403 with cf-mitigated: challenge** ("Just a moment..." JS challenge) to an anonymous client. The query term does not appear in the body — no results are served. This path requires solving a Cloudflare Turnstile/JS challenge (headless browser or a CF-bypass service), which a Go HTTP client cannot do anonymously.

Probe 6 — the JSON API itself is NOT Cloudflare-gated

```
curl -s -o /dev/null -w "http_code=%{http_code}" ".../api/get-
torrents?limit=1&imdb_id=0944947" → http_code=200
```

FACT: /api/get-torrents returns 200 anonymously (no CF challenge). Only the HTML site surface is gated. So the JSON imdb_id path is the only anonymous, machine-usable surface.

Probe 8 + 9 — anonymous, no-key title→IMDb resolver EXISTS

```
curl -s -A "Mozilla/5.0" "https://v3.sg.media-imdb.com/suggestion/
x/game%20of%20thrones.json"
```

Parsed (tt-prefixed entries):

tt0944947	Game of Thrones	TV series	2011
tt11198330	House of the Dragon	TV series	2022
tt2653350	Game of Thrones: Costumes	video	2011

FACT: IMDb's public suggestion endpoint `https://v3.sg.media-imdb.com/suggestion/x/<query>.json` returns `title→ttXXXXXX` mappings **with no API key and no auth** (just a browser UA). It is the autocomplete backend of `imdb.com`. It distinguishes `q:"TV series"` from films/videos, which lets us pick the TV entry EZTV actually carries. (Contrast: OMDb and TMDb both require an API key → would violate the anonymous/no-credentials property of curated providers, so they are rejected.)

Probe 10 + 12 — full chain works mechanically, but has a FALSE-MATCH defect

Game of Thrones: `tt0944947` → strip `tt` → `0944947` → EZTV 146 rows, all "Game of Thrones". CORRECT.

Breaking Bad:

`W=$(curl ... suggestion .../breaking%20bad.json | pick first TV-series tt) → tt0903747`

`curl ".../get-torrents?limit=2&imdb_id=0903747"`

→ `"torrents_count":77`

→ `"title":"Breaking Brad S02E02 ... EZTV"`

→ `"title":"Breaking Brad S09E02 ... EZTV"`

FACT — IMPORTANT DEFECT: The IMDb-suggest top "TV series" hit for "breaking bad" resolved to `tt0903747`, and EZTV returned **77 rows titled "Breaking Brad"** — a different show, not "Breaking Bad". Two non-exclusive explanations, neither yet isolated:

- UNCONFIRMED: the IMDb suggest API returned a wrong/ambiguous id for the bare query "breaking bad" (the canonical Breaking Bad id is `tt0903747` per common knowledge, so the id may be right and EZTV's per-row `imdb_id` tagging may be wrong);
- UNCONFIRMED: EZTV's per-torrent `imdb_id` field is operator-supplied and sometimes mis-tagged, so an `imdb_id` query can surface mislabeled rows.

The honesty consequence is the same regardless of cause: **the title→imdb→get-torrents chain can return results that do not match the user's typed title**. This is a \$6.E/\$6.L risk surface that any shipped implementation MUST mitigate (e.g. post-filter returned rows by fuzzy title match against the query, and/or pin to a curated id map rather than live-resolving).

Probe 13 — replacement candidate torrents-csv has genuine free-text search (re-confirm)

```
curl -s "https://torrents-csv.com/service/search?q=batman&size=2"
→ {"torrents":[{"infohash":"0c23e50e...", "name":"The Batman
(2022) [1080p] [WEBRip] [5.1] [YTS.MX]", "seeders":357,...},{...}]}
```

FACT: torrents-csv.com/service/search?q= genuinely filters by free text (batman → "The Batman (2022)", with real seeder counts), anonymously, JSON, no key. This is the already-shipped 2nd curated provider in lava-api-go.

2. Findings table

Endpoint / approach	Anonymous?	Cloudflare-gated?	Genuinely filters by free-text title?	Evidence
GET /api/get-torrents? keywords=<q>	Yes	No (200)	NO — param ignored	Probe 1/2: ironman and batman both return count 1055208 + identical first row
GET /api/get-torrents?q=<q>	Yes	No	NO — ignored	Probe 7: count 1055208
GET /api/get-torrents? search=<q>	Yes	No	NO — ignored	Probe 7: count 1055208
GET /api/get-torrents? imdb_id=<padded7>	Yes	No (200)	Partial — filters by IMDb id, NOT free text; TV-only; needs zero-pad; can mis-match	Probe 3/4/11/12

Endpoint / approach	Anonymous?	Cloudflare-gated?	Genuinely filters by free-text title?	Evidence
GET /search/<query> (HTML)	No (needs CF solve)	YES — 403 cf-mitigated: challenge	n/a (blocked)	Probe 5: 403, "Just a moment", 0 hits in body
IMDb suggest v3.sg.media-imdb.com/suggestion/x/<q>.json	Yes (no key)	No	title→tt id (resolver only, not a tracker)	Probe 8/9
Chain: IMDb-suggest → strip tt → imdb_id=	Yes	No	Approximate — works for GoT; FALSE-MATCHED "breaking bad"→"Breaking Brad"	Probe 10/12
Jackett's own EZTV definition (eztv.yml)	—	—	Scrapes the HTML search/<kw> page (the CF-gated one)	\$3 below
torrents-csv.com/service/search?q= (replacement)	Yes (no key)	No	YES	Probe 13

3. How mature integrations (Jackett) do EZTV title search

Jackett's current EZTV indexer is a **Cardigann YAML definition**, not the JSON API. Fetched live from <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Jackett/Jackett/master/src/Jackett.Common/Definitions/eztv.yml>:

```
caps:
  modes:
    search: [q]
    tv-search: [q, season, ep]
search:
```

```

paths:
  - path: "{{ if .Keywords }}search/{{ .Keywords }}{{ else }}home{{ end }}"
keywordsfilters:
  - name: re_replace
    args: ["\\bS\\d{2,3}\\b", ""] # strip season tag – search
                                # doesn't support it
  - name: trim
  - name: replace
    args: ["-", ""]
  - name: replace
    args: [" ", "-"] # spaces → hyphens
  - name: replace
    args: ["&", ""]
headers:
  cookie: ["sort_no=100; q_filter=all; ... layout=def_wlinks"]
rows:
  selector: "table.forum_header_border:contains('Latest')
            tr[name='hover']... :has(a.magnet), ...:contains('Releases')..."
filters:
  - name: andmatch # client-side AND-match of keyword
                  # terms against parsed rows

```

FACT: Jakkett does **NOT** use the JSON API for EZTV search and does **NOT** use `imdb_id`. It requests the **HTML page** `https://<eztv-mirror>/search/<hyphenated-keywords>`, parses the results `<table>` rows, and applies a client-side `andmatch` keyword filter on the parsed titles. EZTV's own search "doesn't support" season tags (Jakkett strips them), confirming EZTV HTML search is a crude substring-on-title match.

Consequence for lava-api-go: Jakkett's path is exactly the surface Probe 5 proved is **Cloudflare-challenge-gated (403)** for an anonymous HTTP client. Jakkett works because it (a) runs with a configurable FlareSolvrr/Cloudflare-bypass proxy and/or per-user mirror selection, and (b) is a user-hosted app, not an anonymous server-side scraper. `lava-api-go` curated providers are anonymous, no-bypass, server-side Go HTTP — they cannot reproduce Jakkett's path honestly. **UNCONFIRMED:** whether specific listed mirrors (`eztv.wf`, `eztv.tf`, `eztv.yt`, `eztv1.xyz`) are un-gated; the primary `eztvx.to` is gated. Mirror-roulette is not a stable basis for a shipped capability.

4. Title→IMDb resolver evaluation (task 3)

- **IMDb suggest API** (`v3.sg.media-imdb.com/suggestion/x/<q>.json`): anonymous, no key, returns title→tt id + media-type. **Viable as a resolver.** Risks: (a) it is an undocumented endpoint that could change/rate-limit without notice (**UNCONFIRMED:** long-term stability);

(b) ambiguous queries resolve to the wrong id (Probe 12 "breaking bad"→"Breaking Brad" false match); (c) adds an extra network hop + external dependency into every EZTV search.

- **OMDb / TMDb**: both require an API key → **REJECTED** — violates the anonymous/no-credentials property that defines a curated provider in this project (§6.H credential-inviolability + the curated-provider design contract).
 - **Net**: a key-free resolver exists, but the chain's free-text fidelity is only *approximate* and demonstrably wrong for at least one common query. Shipping it as a free-text CapSearch would be borderline-bluff under §6.E unless paired with a strict post-filter (returned-row title must fuzzy-match the user query) — and even then it cannot find shows EZTV failed to imdb-tag.
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5. RECOMMENDATION

Primary: [skip EZTV] as a free-text-search curated provider.

Rationale (all captured, not surmised):

1. EZTV's JSON API has **no working free-text param** — keywords, q, search are all silently ignored (Probe 1/2/7). Declaring a free-text SEARCH capability against it is the exact §6.E/§6.L "search ignores the query" bluff that is STRICTLY FORBIDDEN here.
2. The only genuine HTML title-search surface is **hard Cloudflare-challenge-gated (HTTP 403, cf-mitigated: challenge)** for anonymous clients (Probe 5) — the same surface Jackett uses, which is why Jackett needs a CF-bypass and a user host. lava-api-go anonymous server-side Go cannot replicate it honestly.
3. The `imdb_id` workaround is **not free-text search**: it is TV-only, zero-pad-sensitive, requires an external IMDb-suggest hop, and **produced a false match** ("breaking bad" → "Breaking Brad", Probe 12). It cannot honestly back a free-text CapSearch.

Strongest single piece of evidence for the recommendation: Probe 1/2 — keywords=ironman and keywords=batman return the **byte-identical** global list (`torrents_count:1055208`, first row "Iron Man and His Awesome Friends" for *both* queries). The query has zero effect on the JSON API output. Any free-text SEARCH capability declared against this endpoint is provably non-functional, i.e. a constitutional bluff.

Acceptable honest alternatives, in priority order

- **(A) [replace EZTV with another free-text JSON tracker] — RECOMMENDED concrete action.** The already-probed, already-shipped `torrents-csv.com/service/search?q=` (Probe 13) and `apibay.org` (The Pirate Bay) both have genuine anonymous key-free free-text JSON search and **already cover TV content** (Probe 13's batman result set includes TV-style releases). EZTV adds no honest free-text capability the existing two providers lack. Net: do not add EZTV; the curated set's free-text search is already satisfied by TPB + `torrents-csv`.
- **(B) [ship EZTV honestly with `imdb-id-only`, no free-text CapSearch] — only if a *browse/by-show* capability is explicitly wanted.** EZTV could be exposed as an **IMDb-id / by-show browse** provider that does NOT declare free-text CapSearch. The `imdb_id` filter is genuine (Probe 4: 146 real GoT rows). This is honest *only* if the capability surfaced to the user is "browse a show by its IMDb id", not "free-text search". It would still require: zero-padding the id, and (if title-driven) a strict post-filter on returned-row titles to defend against the Probe-12 false-match class. This is more wiring for a narrower, non-free-text capability — recommend only on explicit product demand.
- **(C) [ship EZTV honestly with HTML-search parse] — REJECTED.** Blocked by Cloudflare (Probe 5). Would require a CF-bypass dependency, violating the anonymous/no-credentials curated-provider contract. Do not pursue.

Bottom line: Nothing on EZTV gives anonymous, server-side, genuine free-text title search. Recommend **skipping EZTV** and relying on the two providers that already have honest free-text JSON search (The Pirate Bay + Torrents-CSV). If a by-show capability is later wanted, option (B) (imdb-id browse, no free-text CapSearch, with title post-filter) is the only honest EZTV path.